

TRYHACKME ROOM

WINDOWS FUNDAMENTELS

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The Windows operating system has a long history dating back to 1985, and currently, it is the dominant operating system in both home use and corporate networks. Because of this, Windows has always been targeted by hackers & malware writers.

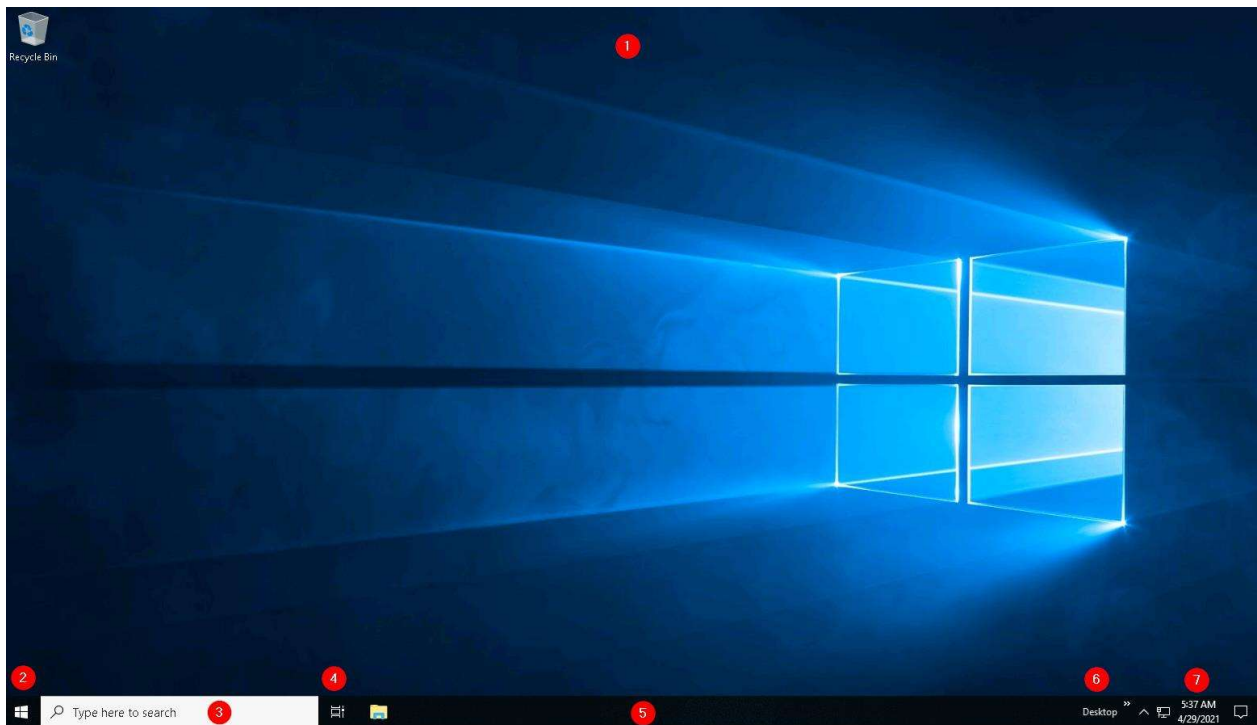
Windows XP was a popular version of Windows for a long time. Then, Microsoft announced Windows Vista, which was a complete overhaul of the Windows operating system. There were many issues with Windows Vista. It wasn't received well by Windows users, and it was quickly phased out.

When Microsoft announced the end-of-life date for Windows XP, many customers panicked. Corporations, hospitals, etc., scrambled and tested the next viable Windows version, which was Windows 7, against many other hardware and devices. Vendors had to work against the clock to ensure their products worked with Windows 7 for their customers. If they couldn't, their customers had to break their agreement and find another vendor that upgraded their products to work with Windows 7. It was a nightmare for many, and Microsoft took note of it.

Windows 7, as quickly as it was released soon after, was marked with an end of support date. Windows 8.x came and left and it was short-lived, like Vista.

The Windows Desktop, aka the graphical user interface or GUI in short, is the screen that welcomes you once you log into a Windows 10 machine.

Traditionally, you need to pass the login screen first. The login screen is where you need to enter valid account credentials; usually, a username & password of a preexisting Windows account on that particular system or in the Active Directory environment (if it's a domain-joined machine).



The above screenshot is an example of a typical Windows Desktop. Each component that makes up the GUI is explained briefly below.

1. The Desktop
2. Start Menu
3. Search Box (Cortana)
4. Task View
5. Taskbar
6. Toolbars
7. Notification Area

FILE SYSTEM

The file system used in modern versions of Windows is the **New Technology File System** or simply [NTFS \(opens in new tab\)](#).

Before NTFS, there was **FAT16/FAT32** (File Allocation Table) and **HPFS** (High Performance File System).

You still see FAT partitions in use today. For example, you typically see FAT partitions in USB devices, MicroSD cards, etc. but traditionally not on personal Windows computers/laptops or Windows servers.

NTFS is known as a journaling file system. In case of a failure, the file system can automatically repair the folders/files on disk using information stored in a log file. This function is not possible with FAT.

Let's speak briefly on some features that are specific to NTFS.

On NTFS volumes, you can set permissions that grant or deny access to files and folders.

The permissions are:

- **Full control**
- **Modify**
- **Read & Execute**
- **List folder contents**
- **Read**
- **Write**

The Windows folder () is traditionally known as the folder which contains the Windows operating system.

The folder doesn't have to reside in the C drive necessarily. It can reside in any other drive and technically can reside in a different folder.

This is where environment variables, more specifically system environment variables, come into play. Even though not discussed yet, the system environment variable for the Windows directory is .

USER ACCOUNT AND PROFILE PERMISSIONS

User accounts can be one of two types on a typical local Windows system: **Administrator** & **Standard User**.

The user account type will determine what actions the user can perform on that specific Windows system.

- An Administrator can make changes to the system: add users, delete users, modify groups, modify settings on the system, etc.
- A Standard User can only make changes to folders/files attributed to the user & can't perform system-level changes, such as install programs.

You are currently logged in as an Administrator. There are several ways to determine which user accounts exist on the system.

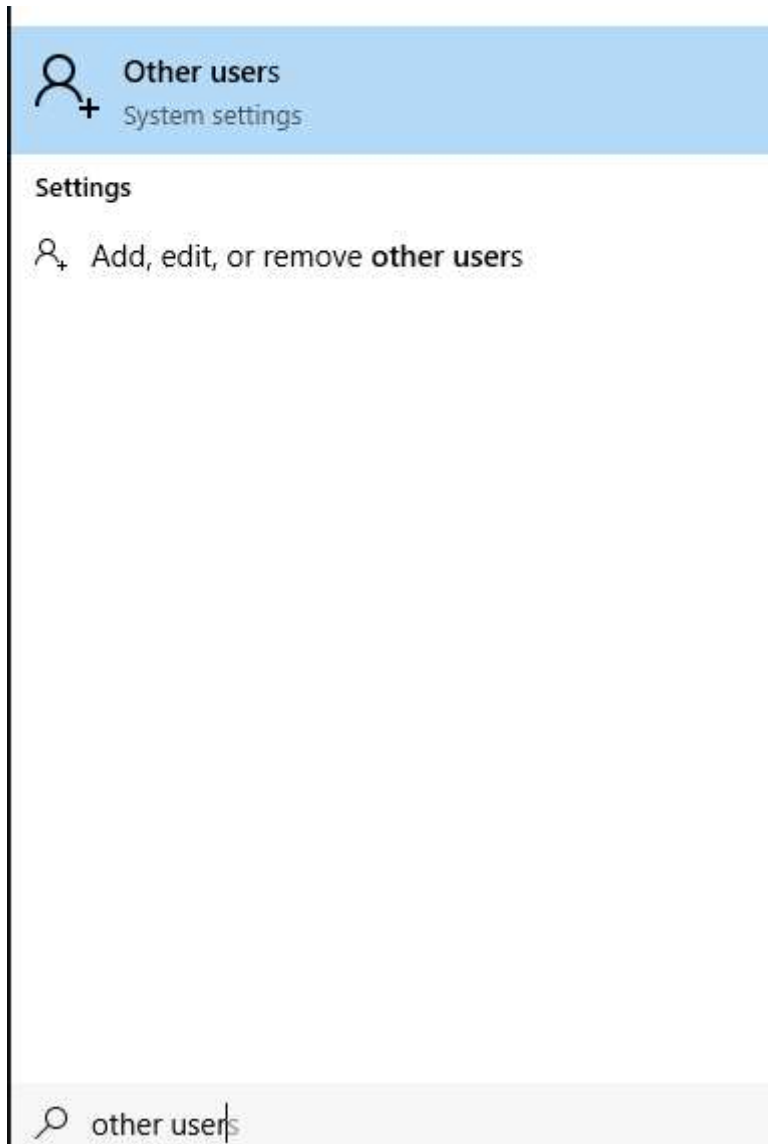
One way is to click the and type . A shortcut to should appear.

USER ACCOUNT CONTROL

The large majority of home users are logged into their Windows systems as local administrators. Remember from the previous task that any user with administrator as the account type can make changes to the system.

A user doesn't need to run with high (elevated) privileges on the system to run tasks that don't require such privileges, such as surfing the Internet, working on a Word document, etc. This elevated privilege increases the risk of system compromise because it makes it easier for malware to infect the system. Consequently, since the user account can make changes to the system, the malware would run in the context of the logged-in user.

To protect the local user with such privileges, Microsoft introduced **User Account Control (UAC)**. This concept was first introduced with the short-lived [Windows Vista \(opens in new tab\)](#) and continued with versions of Windows that followed.

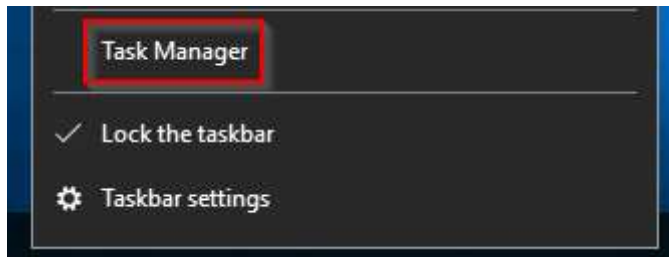


TASK MANAGER

The last subject that will be touched on in this module is the **Task Manager**.

The Task Manager provides information about the applications and processes currently running on the system. Other information is also available, such as how much CPU and RAM are being utilized, which falls under **Performance**.

You can access the Task Manager by right-clicking the taskbar.



QUESTIONS AND ANSWER

Answer the questions below

What is the name of the other user account?

tryhackmebilly

✓ Correct Answer

What groups is this user a member of?

Remote Desktop Users,Users

✓ Correct Answer

What built-in account is for guest access to the computer?

Guest

✓ Correct Answer

What is the account description?

window\$Fun1!

✓ Correct Answer

Answer the questions below

Which selection will hide/disable the Search box?

Hidden

✓ Correct Answer

Which selection will hide/disable the Task View button?

Show Task View button

✓ Correct Answer

Besides Clock and Network, what other icon is visible in the Notification Area?

Action Center

✓ Correct Answer



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